

ESL Picture Book Lesson Plan

Book: Kitty Cat and the Frog by Annette Smith, illustrated by Ben Spiby

Level: Beginner / Elementary (early narrative reader)

Duration: 25 minutes

Teaching Intention Analysis

Story Summary: Kitty Cat meets a little frog by the pond. When Fat Cat comes to catch the frog, Kitty Cat distracts him so the frog can get away safely.

Teaching Goals:

- Language Goal: Simple past tense storytelling (went, ran, looked, hit, came, said)
- Vocabulary Goal: Animal actions and story phrases (ran, hit, went into, came out of, get away)
- Thinking Goal: Understanding character motivation and problem-solving (why characters act; predicting outcomes)

Part 1: Greeting & Warm-up (0:00–3:00) — Cover / Page 1

Hello! How are you today?

I'm fine, thank you!

What can you see in the picture?

I can see a cat and a frog.

What is the cat doing?

The cat is hiding in the grass.

Where is the frog?

The frog is by the pond.

What sound does a cat make?

A cat says "meow."

Part 2: Reading (3:00–20:00)

Page 2 — "Kitty Cat went outside. She liked to sit in the sun. 'Fat Cat is not here,' she said. 'I will be safe.'"

Where did Kitty Cat go?

Kitty Cat went outside.

What did Kitty Cat like to do?

She liked to sit in the sun.

Why did Kitty Cat feel safe outside?

She felt safe because Fat Cat was not there.

went — past tense of "go"

safe — not in danger

Page 3 — "Kitty Cat lay down in the grass by the pond. A little green frog came out of the grass."

Where did Kitty Cat lie down?

She lay down in the grass by the pond.

What came out of the grass?

A little green frog came out of the grass.

What color was the frog?

The frog was green.

lay down — past tense of "lie down"

came out of — moved from inside to outside of something

Page 4 — "Kitty Cat looked up. 'Meow!' said Kitty Cat. The little frog went into the water."

What did Kitty Cat do when she saw the frog?

She looked up and said "Meow!"

What did the frog do?

The frog went into the water.

Why do you think the frog went into the water?

I think the frog went into the water because _____. (it was scared of Kitty Cat)

went into — moved to the inside of something

look up — to raise your eyes and look

Page 5 — "Oh, no!" said Kitty Cat. 'Here comes Fat Cat. He will get the little frog.'"

Who is coming?

Fat Cat is coming.

What does Kitty Cat think Fat Cat will do?

She thinks Fat Cat will get the little frog.

How do you think Kitty Cat feels?

I think Kitty Cat feels _____. (worried, scared)

get — here, to catch

worried — feeling nervous about something bad happening

Page 6 — "Fat Cat ran to the pond. He looked at the little frog in the water. Fat Cat's tail went up and down, up and down."

Where did Fat Cat run?

Fat Cat ran to the pond.

What did Fat Cat's tail do?

His tail went up and down.

Why do you think Fat Cat's tail went up and down?

I think his tail went up and down because _____. (he was excited to catch the frog)

ran — past tense of "run"

tail — the part at the back of an animal's body

Page 7 — "'I will help the little frog,' said Kitty Cat. She hit Fat Cat's tail with her paw. 'Meow!' said Fat Cat. 'Go away, Kitty Cat.'"

What did Kitty Cat decide to do?

She decided to help the little frog.

What did Kitty Cat hit with her paw?

She hit Fat Cat's tail with her paw.

How would you help the frog?

I would _____.

hit — to strike something with force

paw — an animal's foot

go away — to leave a place

Page 8 — "Kitty Cat hit Fat Cat's tail again. 'Meow!' said Fat Cat. Kitty Cat ran. Fat Cat ran after her."

What did Kitty Cat do again?

She hit Fat Cat's tail again.

What did Fat Cat do after that?

Fat Cat ran after Kitty Cat.

again — one more time

ran after — to run in order to catch someone

Page 9 — "'Good,' said Kitty Cat. 'The little frog can get away.'"

What could the little frog do now?

The little frog could get away.

Why was Kitty Cat happy at the end?

She was happy because _____. (she helped the frog get away safely)

get away — to escape from danger

Grammar Focus

went — past tense of "go"

Story Example: "Kitty Cat went outside."

Student Sentence Frame:

First, _____ went _____. (e.g., First, Kitty Cat went outside.)

Other past tense verbs in the story: ran, looked, came, said, hit, lay down.

Part 3: Game & Wrap-up (20:00–25:00)

Game 1: What Happened Next?

Target language: went, ran, looked, said, hit (simple past)

How to play: The teacher reads one sentence from the story (e.g., "Fat Cat ran to the pond.") without showing the picture. The student

guesses what happens next using the frame "I think next, _____."
Then the teacher reveals the real next event so the student can compare.

Student output: Past-tense prediction sentences using story vocabulary.

Game 2: Cat or Frog?

Target language: I will _____. / He/She will _____.

How to play: The teacher names a character (Kitty Cat, Fat Cat, or the frog). The student speaks one sentence in that character's voice about what they will do next, using "I will _____." Then the student picks a character for the teacher.

Student output: First-person sentences using "will" + base verb.

Story Retelling

First, Kitty Cat went outside because _____. (she liked to sit in the sun)

Then, a little frog came out of the grass, and it went into the water because _____. (it was scared of Kitty Cat)

Next, Fat Cat ran to the pond because _____. (he wanted to catch the frog)

After that, Kitty Cat hit Fat Cat's tail because _____. (she wanted to help the frog)

Finally, the little frog could get away because _____. (Kitty Cat stopped Fat Cat)